

Education/Training

2023 - Present	Postdoctoral Associate (Duke University) Advised by Surya Tokdar and Jennifer Groh Department of Statistical Science
2018 - 2023	Ph.D. in Biostatistics (University of California, Los Angeles) Advised by Donatello Telesca Additional Committee Members: Damla Şentürk, Michele Guindani, Joanne Weidhaas
2014 - 2017	B.S. in Mathematics: Option in Statistics (California State University, Long Beach) Honors: Summa Cum Laude, Departmental Honors

Awards

- Duke Postdoctoral Award for Professional Development (2025)
- Honorable Mention for the [Savage Award](#) in Applied Methodology (2024)
- Junior Travel Award, ISBA World Meeting (2024)
- Poster Award, Objective Bayes Methodology Conference (2022)
- Junior Travel Award, ISBA World Meeting (2022)

Publications/ Preprints

- Leeman, J. M., Willett, S. M., **Marco, N.**, Tokdar, S. T., & Groh, J. M. (2026). Neural multiplexing vs place coding: Multiplexing steps in when most needed. *bioRxiv* 2026.08.06.743261.
- **Marco, N.** & Tokdar, S. T. (2026). Adaptive Generalized Elliptical Slice Sampling. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.21659*.
- Telesca, D., **Marco, N.**, & Landry, E. (2026). Mixed Membership Models for Multilevel Functional Data. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2604.09910*.
- **Marco, N.**, Şentürk, D., Jeste, S., DiStefano, C., Dickinson, A., & Telesca, D. (2025). Covariate Adjusted Functional Mixed Membership Models. *Statistics and Data Science in Imaging*, 2(1).
- Weidhaas, J. B., McGreevy, K. M., **Marco, N.**, Sundahl, N., Cabanski, C. R., Spencer, C., ... & Telesca, D. (2025). Germline microRNA-based signatures predict toxicity and response to anti-CTLA-4 therapy. *Journal of Translational Medicine*, 23(1), 848.
- Shamshoian, J., **Marco, N.**, Şentürk, D., Jeste, S., & Telesca, D. (2025). Bayesian covariance regression in functional data analysis with applications to functional brain imaging. *The International Journal of Biostatistics*.
- **Marco, N.**, Groh, J. M., & Tokdar, S. T. (2024). Modeling Neural Switching via Drift-Diffusion Models. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2410.00781*.
- **Marco, N.**, Şentürk, D., Jeste, S., DiStefano, C. C., Dickinson, A., & Telesca, D. (2024). Flexible regularized estimation in high-dimensional mixed membership models. *Computational statistics & data analysis*, 194, 107931.
- **Marco, N.**, Şentürk, D., Jeste, S., DiStefano, C., Dickinson, A., & Telesca, D. (2024). Functional mixed membership models. *Journal of Computational and Graphical Statistics*, 33(4), 1139-1149.
- Weidhaas, J. B., **Marco, N.**, Steinberg, M. L., Lee, A., Xiang, M., Valle, L. F., ... & Kishan, A. U. (2023). Early findings from the GARUDA trial: The impact of a genetic signature of late radiation toxicity on prostate cancer treatment decision making.
- Kishan, A. U., **Marco, N.**, Ma, T. M., Steinberg, M. L., Sachdeva, A., Cao, M., ... & Weidhaas, J. B. (2023). Application of a genetic signature of late GU toxicity in SCIMITAR, a Post-op SBRT trial. *Clinical and Translational Radiation Oncology*, 39, 100594.

- Gunatilaka, A. B., **Marco, N.**, Read, G. H., Sweeney, M., Regan, G., Tsang, C., ... & Weidhaas, J. B. (2022). Viral burden and clearance in asymptomatic COVID-19 Patients. In Open forum infectious diseases (Vol. 9, No. 5, p. ofac126). US: Oxford University Press.
- Weidhaas, J., **Marco, N.**, Scheffler, A. W., Kalbasi, A., Wilenius, K., Rietdorf, E., ... & Telesca, D. (2022). Germline biomarkers predict toxicity to anti-PD1/PDL1 checkpoint therapy. Journal for immunotherapy of cancer, 10(2).
- Kishan, A. U., **Marco, N.**, Schulz-Jaavall, M. B., Steinberg, M. L., Tran, P. T., Juarez, J. E., ... & Weidhaas, J. B. (2022). Germline variants disrupting microRNAs predict long-term genitourinary toxicity after prostate cancer radiation. Radiotherapy and Oncology, 167, 226-232.

Presentations

- Adaptive Generalized Elliptical Slice Sampling, **Poster**, Adventures in Sampling, Durham, NC, USA, September 2026
- Adaptive Generalized Elliptical Slice Sampling, **Poster**, 2026 ISBA World Meeting, Nagoya, Japan, July 2026
- Modeling Neural Switching via Drift-Diffusion Models, **Seminar**, Duke Statistical Science, Durham, NC, USA, February 2026
- Modeling Neural Switching via Drift-Diffusion Models, **Seminar**, NCSU FDA research seminar, Raleigh, NC, USA, January 2026
- Mixed Membership Models with Applications to Neuroimaging, **Contributed Presentation**, Joint Statistical Meetings (JSM), Nashville, TN, USA, August 2025
- Modeling Neural Switching via Drift-Diffusion Models, **Contributed Presentation**, Bayesian Inference in Stochastic Processes (BISP) 14, Milan, Italy, May 2025
- Modeling Neural Switching via Drift-Diffusion Models, **Invited Presentation**, Statistical Methods in Imaging (SMI), Houston, TX, USA, May 2025
- Modeling Neural Switching via Drift-Diffusion Models, **Poster**, Computational and Systems Neuroscience (COSYNE), Montreal, Canada, March 2025
- Modeling Neural Switching via Drift-Diffusion Models, **Poster**, Duke University Statistical Science Research Alumni Symposium, Durham, NC, USA, October 2024
- Modeling Neural Switching via Drift-Diffusion Models, **Seminar**, Duke University Computational and Theoretical Neuroscience Seminar, Durham, NC, USA, October 2024
- Modeling Functional Brain Imaging Data with Mixed Membership Models, **Joint Contributed Presentation with Donatello Telesca**, 2024 ISBA World Meeting, Venice, Italy, July 2024
- Modeling Neural Switching via Drift-Diffusion Models, **Poster**, 2024 ISBA World Meeting, Venice, Italy, July 2024
- Functional Mixed Membership Models, **Invited Presentation**, California State University, Long Beach Math Colloquium, Long Beach, CA, USA, March 2023
- Functional Partial Membership Models, **Joint Invited Presentation with Donatello Telesca**, O'Bayes 2022: Objective Bayes Methodology Conference, Santa Cruz, CA, USA, September 2022
- Functional Partial Membership Models, **Poster**, O'Bayes 2022: Objective Bayes Methodology Conference, Santa Cruz, CA, USA, September 2022
- Bayesian Functional Partial Membership Models, **Contributed Presentation**, Joint Statistical Meetings, Washington D.C., USA, August 2022
- Bayesian Functional Partial Membership Models, **Poster**, 2022 ISBA World Meeting, Montreal, Canada, June 2022

Teaching Experience

09/2018 – 06/2019 **Teaching Assistant**
University of California, Los Angeles

Role outline

As a teaching assistant for an introductory biostatistics course, I worked with first year master’s students and third/fourth-year undergraduates across six different class sections. My responsibilities included leading weekly lab sessions, holding office hours, and organizing and facilitating review sessions.

Service and Professional Membership

2024 – **Reviewer, Biostatistics**
2023 – **Reviewer, Biometrics**
2022 – **Member, American Statistical Association**
2022 – **Member, International Society of Bayesian Analytics**

Industry Experience

01/2018 – 08/2018 **Systems Engineer**
Northrop Grumman Corporation (Redondo Beach, CA)
05/2017 – 07/2017 **Software Engineer Intern**
Northrop Grumman Corporation (Redondo Beach, CA)